



Bulletin

Last updated 22-08-2026 at 09:35 — Covering sources published on 21 and 22 August 2026

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies plans and policies

[Nigeria Inaugurates Technical Committee on Sovereign Cloud Initiative](#) — Voice of Nigeria, 21 August 2026

NIGERIA

Nigeria has inaugurated a Joint Technical Committee on its National Sovereign Cloud Initiative in Abuja, chaired by Budget Office director-general Tanimu Yakubu with NITDA's Kashifu Inuwa Abdullahi as co-chair, to align federal cloud spending, procurement and financing behind the initiative. NITDA put federal IT project submissions for 2023 to 2026 at over N4.2 trillion, of which about N3.89 trillion was identified and more than N400 billion saved through review. *Also under [Data Storage](#) and [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#).*

[Malawi targets smartphone tax relief](#) — ITWeb Africa, 21 August 2026

MALAWI

Malawi's ICT minister Shadric Namalomba has called for the 10% surtax on internet services to be scrapped and the 17.5% VAT on smartphones reviewed, setting a target of lifting mobile internet use from 12.5% to at least 30% by 2030. The regulator MACRA said it is evaluating Universal Service Fund mechanisms to subsidise consumer devices and fund digital-literacy work, including a proposed one-tablet-one-student programme. *Also under [Digital divides](#).*

[IN Groupe eyes Kenyan market](#) — ITWeb Africa, 21 August 2026

KENYA

Kenya has opened talks with the French secure-identity provider IN Groupe on a national authentication platform that would let citizens reach public and private services through a single digital identity. ICT and Digital Economy Cabinet Secretary William Kabogo Gitau hosted a delegation led by Celine Gouveia in Nairobi and both sides agreed to deepen technical and policy collaboration; no contract, value or timetable was announced. *Also under [Digital Identity and CRVS](#), [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#) and [ICT Industry](#).*

Legislation and regulation

[Nigeria's Central Bank wants to monitor your stablecoin transactions. Can the plan actually work?](#) — TechCabal, 21 August 2026

NIGERIA

The Central Bank of Nigeria intends to run its own observer nodes on the blockchains carrying approved stablecoins, giving it a real-time view of how the tokens are issued, moved and redeemed rather than relying on what issuers report. The provision sits in its Payments System Vision 2028, which TechCabal reads against Kenya's capital markets regulator tendering for blockchain analytics in June 2026 and an estimated \$205 billion of digital-currency flows across Sub-Saharan Africa in the year to June 2025. Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).

Kenya Information and Communication Bill a solution looking for a problem — Daily Nation, 21 August 2026

KENYA

Writing in the Daily Nation, communications consultant Mutuma Mathiu argued that the Kenya Information and Communication (Amendment) Bill 2025 is surveillance presented as consumer protection: it would oblige internet service providers to fit numbered billing meters, verify subscribers and report meter and billing-system data annually to the Communications Authority, while fixing no price, capping no tariff and mandating no subsidy. He set that against the National Broadband Strategy 2025-2030 target of cutting fixed broadband from 13.4% to 2% of household income. Also under [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#), [Access to services](#) and [Connectivity](#).

Internet firm warns proposed metered billing could raise costs for Kenyans — People Daily, 21 August 2026

KENYA

Liquid Intelligent Technologies told the National Assembly Committee on Communication, Information and Innovation that mandatory metered internet billing under the Kenya Information and Communications (Amendment) Bill No. 9 of 2025 would raise costs, undermine fixed and unlimited packages, and expose businesses to bill shock from automated traffic they did not initiate. It added that tracking usage at that granularity raises data-protection and surveillance concerns. Also under [Connectivity](#), [Access to services](#) and [Data protection](#).

CIB Secures Preliminary Approval to Launch yomo Digital Bank in Egypt — Tech Africa News, 21 August 2026

EGYPT

The Central Bank of Egypt has given CIB preliminary approval to establish yomo, a digitally native bank, under the digital banks framework Egypt introduced in 2023. yomo now enters technology validation, cybersecurity testing and operational-resilience readiness under newly appointed chief executive Rashwan Hammady, with launch still subject to final regulatory approval. Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).

Data protection

UNITEL Restores Core Mobile Services Nationwide After July Cyberattack — Tech Africa News, 21 August 2026

ANGOLA

UNITEL has declared its core mobile services fully restored across Angola after the 28 July cyberattack, with only its custom ringback-tone feature still offline. A forensic investigation with independent external experts continues and has so far found no evidence that customer or partner personal data was accessed or shared; affected users are receiving automatic invoice credits or extra service days. Also under [Cybersecurity](#) and [Connectivity](#).

Internet firm warns proposed metered billing could raise costs for Kenyans — People Daily, 21 August 2026

KENYA

Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

Standards

[AI adoption exposes governance gaps as organisations race to keep up](#) — ITWeb South Africa, 21 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

A panel at TrendAI Spark 2026 in Sun City argued that South African organisations are deploying artificial intelligence faster than they can govern it. Eskom's Norbit Williams warned against governing so tightly that the technology cannot be used effectively, while Warwyck Private Bank's Roopesh Mohabeer said security teams need to know what information staff are sending to external platforms and to keep validating what comes back. Also under [AI](#) and [Cybersecurity](#).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

[Kenya Information and Communication Bill a solution looking for a problem](#) — Daily Nation, 21 August 2026

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Finance

New investments

[Kenya and KEXIM Advance Talks on Digital Media City Project at Konza Technopolis](#) — Tech Africa News, 21 August 2026

KENYA

Kenya's ICT and digital economy principal secretary John Tanui received a Korea Eximbank delegation led by executive director Yongjin Jeong after the bank's due-diligence mission at Konza Technopolis, and the two sides agreed next steps on the proposed Digital Media City infrastructure project. They also discussed AI data centres and other technology projects; no commitment figure or financing instrument was given. Also under [Data Storage](#) and [Innovation ecosystem](#).

[China's Guodong Plans \\$300 Million Digital Infrastructure Investment in Kenya](#) — Ecofin Agency, 21 August 2026

KENYA

Chinese group Guodong plans to invest about KSh 38.8 billion (\$300 million) in Kenyan telecommunications towers, smart cities, data centres, fibre networks, cloud infrastructure and green digital technologies, investment promotion principal secretary Abubakar Hassan Abubakar said after a 17 August meeting with a company delegation. The government frames the plan as support for its Digital Superhighway programme and its commitment to lay about 100,000 km of fibre. Also under [Connectivity](#) and [China activities](#).

[Afrique du Sud : Yellow boucle une levée de fonds pour accélérer son expansion](#) — wearetech.africa, 21 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

Yellow, a Cape Town asset-financing company that sells solar kits and smartphones to low-income households on instalment terms, has closed a funding round to accelerate its expansion across the continent. It reports a million customers in seven countries and a target of ten million users by 2030; neither the investors nor the amount was named. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#) and [Access to services](#).*

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

[Vodacom Tanzania's 10th AGM Highlights 27.7M Customers and 85% Network Investment Growth](#) — Africa Telecom Review, 21 August 2026

TANZANIA

Vodacom Tanzania told its tenth annual general meeting that it closed the year to 31 March 2026 with 27.7 million customers and capital expenditure up 85.1% to TZS 323.9 billion. It added 444 4G and 25 5G sites, lifting 4G population coverage to 76.3%, reported M-PESA customers up 22.6% and 466 rural sites built since 2013 under the government's rural connectivity programme, and had shareholders approve a TZS 53.5 billion dividend. *Also under [ICT Industry](#).*

[Cell C gains 1.3M subscribers, reduces debt](#) — Connecting Africa, 21 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

Cell C added 1.3 million mobile subscribers and cut net debt 64% to R2.02 billion in its first full year as a JSE-listed company, on group revenue of R12.64 billion for the 12 months to 31 May 2026, up 14% year on year. Its wholesale platform now carries 5.7 million MVNO subscribers, which the company puts at an estimated 80-85% of South Africa's MVNO market; it stays the fourth-largest of five mobile operators. *Also under [ICT Industry](#).*

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Data Storage

[Ericsson and MTN Complete MoMo Cloud Migration Across Four African Markets](#) — Tech Africa News, 21 August 2026

ESWATINI

GHANA

RWANDA

UGANDA

Ericsson and MTN Group Fintech have completed the migration of MTN's mobile money platform in Eswatini, Ghana, Rwanda and Uganda, moving it off a legacy virtualised environment onto a cloud-native Ericsson Fintech Platform. Ericsson reports cuts of up to 86% in CPU processing and database load and up to 80% in API response times; Cameroon is under way, with Benin, the Republic of the Congo and Zambia in discussion. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).*

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Cybersecurity

[Boaz Valkin, l'entrepreneur qui renforce la sécurité des systèmes de paiement](#) — wearetech.africa, 21 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

Falkin, founded in South Africa in 2024, sells banks, financial institutions and web platforms real-time risk screening of links, messages, phone numbers and payment requests, and watches mobile activity in the background for anomalous behaviour and phishing attempts. Co-founder and chief executive Boaz Valkin also serves as a director and adviser at Moment, a fintech building a pan-African payment network. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#) and [Innovation ecosystem](#).*

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Digital Payments and Fintech

[He started Bitoshi as a student with an \\$11.12 allowance. Now it has 60,000 users](#) — TechCabal, 22 August 2026

NIGERIA

Bitoshi, a Nigerian crypto-payments startup, has reached roughly 60,000 users on a founder's account of building settlement rails around the Central Bank of Nigeria's February 2021 direction that banks and other financial institutions close the accounts of crypto businesses. Denied a bank rail, it paid naira out through an algorithmic queue that dispatched transfers across a pool of vendors, and moved to an automated payment-partner integration only after the CBN lifted the restriction in 2023. The founder puts users at about 100 in 2021 and 10,000 by 2023, and transaction volume at about \$100,000 rising to some \$5 million after that integration. *Also under [Innovation ecosystem](#).*

[RSwitch Takes Digital Finance Campaign to Kigali Communities](#) — Tech Africa News, 21 August 2026

RWANDA

RSwitch took its #TwagiyeKashiresi financial-inclusion campaign into the Nyabugogo and Gisozi Agakiriro neighbourhoods of Kigali for two days, demonstrating eKash and opening merchant and personal accounts on the spot. The National Bank of Rwanda, the ICT and innovation ministry, the Rwanda ICT Chamber, banks and mobile money operators took part. *Also under [Access to services](#) and [Literacy](#).*

[Nedbank tests next-gen self-service branches](#) — ITWeb South Africa, 21 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

Nedbank is piloting mall-based Client Connect Zones that pair self-service kiosks with consultant support, starting at Fleurhoff Mall in late August 2026 with wider deployment flagged for the mid to long term. The bank already runs 581 kiosks handling more than half a million transactions a month across over 60 services, dispensing almost 70% of its instant-issued debit cards, 56% of which go to entry-level clients. *Also under [Access to services](#).*

[La fintech de SalyPay franchit 1,1 million de dollars de transactions via WhatsApp](#) — wearetech.africa, 21 August 2026

NIGERIA

Nigerian fintech Saly AI says its SalyPay platform has passed 20,000 users and NGN 1.5 billion in transactions, which the publisher converts at that day's rate to more than \$1.1 million. The service runs transfers and bill payments inside WhatsApp and Telegram, and has added international transactions and dollar virtual cards. *Also under [Innovation ecosystem](#).*

[Airtel Money School Pay Expands Digital Fee Payments to 800+ Schools in Tanzania](#) — Tech Africa News, 21 August 2026

TANZANIA

Airtel Money School Pay now carries digital school-fee payments for more than 800 schools across 16 Tanzanian regions, with Airtel Tanzania targeting 1,000 schools a year. The service shifts fee collection off cash onto mobile transfers, with real-time payment records and settlement direct to school bank accounts. *Also under [Access to services](#).*

2026肯尼亚人民币国际使用暨跨境金融合作推介会举行 — 人民网 (People's Daily Online), 21 August 2026

KENYA

Bank of China held a renminbi and cross-border finance event in Nairobi on 20 August with more than 180 participants, at which its Johannesburg branch named KCB, Equity Bank and Diamond Trust Bank as Kenyan renminbi business partners. The bank says it acts as renminbi clearing bank in South Africa, Zambia and Mauritius, holds renminbi correspondent accounts for commercial banks in more than 20 African countries, and provides indirect CIPS access to over 30 African banks. *Also under [China activities](#).*

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Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

[Kenya Breaks Ground for Kikuyu Digital Hub Under Nationwide 100-Hub Plan](#) — Tech Africa News, 21 August 2026

KENYA

Kenya has broken ground on the Kikuyu Centre of Excellence Digital Hub in Kiambu County, the first under a government plan for 100 such hubs across all 47 counties. The completed facility is to hold music and film production studios, Jitume digital skills centres, Kazi hubs, eCitizen service points, a server room and public Wi-Fi zones. Also under [Access to services](#) and [Training and skills](#).

Technology

AI

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SOUTH AFRICA

Summarised under [Connectivity](#).

Innovation ecosystem

[Younes Ahmane mise sur le covoiturage intelligent pour soulager les usagers](#) — wearetech.africa, 21 August 2026

ALGERIA

Nroho, founded in 2024, matches Algerian drivers and passengers travelling the same route through a mobile application, its algorithms pairing users by destination and departure time. Co-founder and chief executive Younes Ahmane, a student at Algeria's national school of artificial intelligence, frames the platform as an answer to the cost of getting about rather than to congestion.

[L'Egyptien Nour El-Assal numérise le recyclage d'huile pour créer des biocarburants](#) — wearetech.africa, 21 August 2026

EGYPT

Tagaddod, founded in Cairo in 2013, collects used cooking oil and other fats as feedstock for biofuels, and has since 2017 built software and mobile applications for consumers and collectors that map flows, plan collection rounds and trace each step of the supply chain. Chief executive and co-founder Nour El-Assal was selected for the Africa's Business Heroes semi-final in Nairobi on 21 and 22 August.

[He started Bitoshi as a student with an \\$11.12 allowance. Now it has 60,000 users](#) — TechCabal, 22 August 2026

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Literacy

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